# Karma Yoga: Towards Reclaiming India's Soul

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The Bhagavad Gita suggests that there are many ways of attaining nirvana (the ultimate Truth or realizing God)—through Jñāna yoga (knowledge), Bhakti yoga (devotion) and Karma yoga (disinterested action). The Bharat Jodo Yatra (BJY or the Yatra) was an instantiation of the age-old method of Karma yoga to seek the truth—both personal and public. It is in that search that we also find Bharat—the amalgamation of 'Bha' (light) and 'Rati' (revelling in). This has become especially pertinent because, for the past few years, India has been suffering from a manufactured epidemic of moral compromises, falsehoods and regressions (ideological, political, social and cultural). Every day we stray further from satya (truth), tap (austerity), daya (compassion) and daan (generosity)—the four components of Dharma (the divine law). To borrow from the Italian philosopher Antonio Gramsci, 'The old world is dying, and the new world struggles to be born: now is the time of monsters … in this interregnum, a great variety of morbid symptoms appear.'

Today there is a pervasive belief that the State, which was carefully designed to be a neutral and honest adjudicator between India's constituent groups, has no longer been listening to India's constituent groups. Instead, in its lust to impose one party, one leader and one ideology on India's continental diversities, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government 'has